



EPSTEIN AND ISRAEL

Jeffrey Epstein Helped Broker Israeli Security Agreement With Mongolia



MURTAZA HUSSAIN AND RYAN GRIM

SEP 28, 2025

Jeffrey Epstein used his political network and financial resources to help broker a security cooperation agreement between the governments of Israel and Mongolia, according to a trove of leaked emails from former Israeli Prime Minister Ehud Barak. This new set of emails between Barak and Epstein has largely been ignored by the mainstream press, but includes crucial new context on Epstein's operation.

It's well known that Epstein had personal ties to Israel, including to senior political officials like Barak and Ehud Olmert, and that he donated to organizations like Friends of the IDF. But Epstein's activities in Mongolia show, for the first time, that he facilitated a deal that led to a security agreement between Israel and other nations.

The leaked emails were released by Handala, a pro-Palestinian hacking group with speculated [ties to Iran](#). The documents were posted by [Distributed Denial of Secrets](#), a non-profit whistleblower and file-sharing website. Although the emails lack cryptographic signatures, they contain a vast amount of unpublished private photographs and documents from Barak and his inner circle, including information that was not publicly known at the time. (More on the verification at the bottom of the article.)

Messages spanning from 2013 to 2016 show intimate, oftentimes daily correspondence between Barak and Epstein. Their conversations address political business strategy as Epstein coordinated meetings for Barak with other members of his elite circles. In 2008, Epstein pled guilty to charges of "procuring a minor for prostitution"; Barak has denied knowledge of Epstein's sex trafficking and abuse of minors.

This article is the first in a series that will explore Epstein's work on behalf of Israeli military interests, particularly as it relates to his role in the development of Israel's cyber warfare industry.

The rise of Israel's cyber surveillance and weapons industry has been one of the most

hacking tools available as “turnkey” packages to police and military around the world. The spread of “zero-click” exploits that require no interaction from targets, coupled with the proliferation of web-connected devices in homes, offices, and manufacturing facilities, has transformed what is possible for spy agencies and those in their orbit.

In the shadows of Israel’s cyber boom was Jeffrey Epstein, who exploited his network of political and financial elites to help Barak, and ultimately the Israeli government itself, to increase the penetration of Israel’s spy-tech firms into foreign countries. Epstein actively supported the Israeli intelligence industry via venture capital investments and contributions to charitable organizations – “non-governmental” entities that laid the foundation for official Israeli security deal-making. The story of Israel’s 2017 security agreement with Mongolia is a window into the true nature and scope of Epstein’s operation.

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Ehud Barak in Mongolia in April 2013, sent in an email with the subject line, "Me and double dabeshet camel."

How Jeffrey Epstein Helped to Broker an Israeli Security Agreement With Mongolia

By Murtaza Hussain and Ryan Grim

In April 2013, almost exactly one month after leaving his post as Israel's Defense Minister, Ehud Barak visited Mongolia to meet President Tsakhiagiin Elbegdorj and security officials. The Mongolia plan had been set in motion in January of that year, while Barak, the country's former prime minister, was still serving in the Israeli government. The broader goal of the meeting was to promote the Israeli defense industry's introduction into the Mongolian market, while seeking business opportunities for clients of Barak's consulting business. During his visit, Barak received a tour of the Special Operations Forces Training Center near Ulaanbataar.

Not physically present, but helping coordinate events behind the scenes, was Jeffrey Epstein, according to a trove of hacked emails between Epstein and Barak posted by [Distributed Denial of Secrets](#) and confirmed as authentic by Drop Site. Epstein, a New York financier and elite fixer who later became notorious for his role as a sex trafficker, died in jail in 2019. In addition to his criminal activities, he was

Barak's visit to Mongolia aligned with a visit by Terje Rød-Larsen, president of the International Peace Institute, a non-profit think tank specializing in multilateral diplomacy. Barak and Rød-Larsen were both members of Epstein's social circle, and well-acquainted; Rød-Larsen was a key mediator in the 1993 and 1995 Oslo Accord between Israel and the Palestine Liberation Organization, when Barak led the Israel Defense Forces. Before Barak left government, at least by 2010, the two maintained an informal backchannel in Barak's personal email inbox, scheduling meetings and sharing articles on international diplomacy.

On April 21, 2013, Barak arranged a meeting at Epstein's New York mansion for an "overview of the coming days." The next day, Rød-Larsen sent Barak an email with details for a proposed advisory team consisting of "internationally-recognized experts who could facilitate foreign investment in key industries in Mongolia. The draft proposal highlighted the great "opportunity" of Mongolia's "massive natural resources (mostly minerals and metals)," promising to accelerate Mongolia's economic growth and bolster its international status. Barak replied to Rød-Larsen's proposal: "Thoughtful, far looking and necessary."

Re:

From: Jeffrey Epstein <jeevacation@gmail.com>

To: ehud barak <ehbarak1@gmail.com>

4/21/2013, 7:09:12 PM /Search

630

On Sunday, April 21, 2013, ehud barak wrote:

Shall we meet 6pm at your place for a. Overview of the coming days?
EB

Sent from my iPhone

On Apr 21, 2013, at 16:48, Jeffrey Epstein <jeevacation@gmail.com>
wrote:

i will be back tonight at 5

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constitute inside information, and is intended only for
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Jeffrey Epstein

*Correspondence between Barak and Epstein in April 2013 shortly before his departure
for Mongolia. (All timestamps for the emails are Asia/Kabul local time).*

Re: Fw:

From: ehud barak <ehbarak1@gmail.com> To: Terje Rod-Larsen <rod-larsen@ipinst.org>

4/22/2013, 3:57:04 PM /Inbox

Dear Terje

I believe it is a very goody idea. Thoughtful , far looking and necessary.

Best regards

Ehud

Sent from my iPhon

On Apr 22, 2013, at 13:50, Terje Rod-Larsen <rod-larsen@ipinst.org> wrote:

From: Andrea Pfanzelter

To: Terje Rod-Larsen

Sent: Mon Apr 22 06:15:03 2013

Subject:

DRAFT

The International Advisory Team for Mongolia

Background

Mongolia is going through a **dramatic process of transition**. With the end of the Soviet Union, Mongolia went through a peaceful revolution, introducing a multi-party system and a market economy.

Twenty years later, Mongolia has become one the **fastest growing economies in the world** (thanks mainly to its rich natural resources) and a **beacon of democracy** (e.g. by Chairing the Community of Democracies and joining the Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe).

Barak's response to Rød-Larsen's proposal for the Mongolia Advisory Board in April 2013.

The archived conversations show Barak and Epstein arranged two more meetings in New York on April 22 and April 24. Barak landed in Ulaanbataar in the evening of April 26, according to an itinerary emailed by the Consul General of Mongolia to Israel. Early the next morning, Barak tried to reach Epstein for a final phone call: "Jeff hi[.] I can't reach you on any phone. Pl try calling me. In about an hour I shall start meetings he

Re: pl call

From: Jeffrey Epstein <jeevacation@gmail.com>

To: ehud barak <ehbarak1@gmail.com>

4/27/2013, 4:43:51 AM /Inbox!4

i tried call me now 212 533 3739

On Fri, Apr 26, 2013 at 5:42 PM, ehud barak <ehbarak1@gmail.com> wrote:

Jeff hi

I can't reach you on any phone. Pl try calling me. In about an hour I shall start meetings here. It'll be more complicated.

Best

EB

Sent from my iPhone

On Apr 26, 2013, at 16:54, Jeffrey Epstein <jeevacation@gmail.com> wrote:

Imon my cell [212 533 3739](tel:2125333739)

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Barak's message to Epstein shortly after arriving in Mongolia to participate in meetings with Mongolian officials in late April 2013.

On April 27, 2013, the itinerary shows Barak met with the Secretary of the National Security Council of Mongolia, Enkhtuvshin Tsagaandari, followed by President Elbegdorj, the Foreign Minister, and the Defense Minister. At Barak's request, the CE of Israel Weapon Industries (a spin-off of state-owned Israel Military Industries) delivered a gift to Tsagaandari, a Jericho pistol in a box engraved with the date, and message: "in appreciation of friendship, cooperation, and good faith."



Jericho pistol gifted to Secretary of the National Security Council of Mongolia, Enkhtevshin Tsagaandari. Photo sent by the CEO of Israel Weapons Industries to Ehud Barak on April 17, 2013.

Barak saw clear opportunities for profit in Mongolia. During the visit, Barak sent an email to Russian-Israeli oligarch Viktor Vekselberg, asking to speak urgently on the phone. In the days leading up to the trip, Barak had negotiated a consulting agreement to develop energy, mining, and other industrial opportunities for Vekselberg's Renova Group conglomerate. Barak wrote to Vekselberg on April 28: "I'm in Mongolia. Already met with most of the leaders from the President downwards and several business people...I have a thought that could probably help."

On April 29, in between meetings with Mongolian officials and events marking Mongolia's presidency of the Community of Democracies, Rød-Larsen chaired a [panel discussion](#) on the Arab Spring at a democracy promotion event in Ulaanbataar, which Barak joined as a participant. The same day, Rød-Larsen signed a [Memorandum of Understanding](#) with Mongolian Foreign Minister Luvsanvandan Bold to deepen the country's cooperation with IPI.

Epstein began recruiting his associates to participate in IPI's Mongolia advisory council. On September 28, 2013, Epstein emailed Barak to float the idea of working alongside Lawrence Summers, a Harvard economist who served in the Clinton and

work well with you.” Barak responded affirmatively: “I think greatly of him especially re to advise for Sovereign Heads. We can complement each other effectively with a of synergies.”

In December 2013, IPI submitted a “Mongolia Presidential Advisory Agreement” to Mongolian authorities, establishing the group of experts who would advise on institutional reforms to promote “global peace and security.” The agreement also stipulated a \$100,000 payment to each member of the Mongolia Presidential Advis Board, according to a 2020 investigation by Norwegian newspaper Dagens Nærings (DN).

On January 24, 2014, the Advisory Board held its inaugural meeting at the Intercontinental Hotel in Davos, Switzerland, attended by the Mongolian President a National Security Advisor, Rød-Larsen, and Lawrence Summers. Joining by telephor were Kjell Bondevik (former PM of Norway), Kevin Rudd (former PM of Australia), Barak, and Epstein. Epstein’s professional affiliation in the meeting agenda was listd as “financier.”

The Davos meeting coincided with that year’s World Economic Forum (WEF), an annual gathering of global elites. News reports confirm [Summers attended](#) that yea confab. The Intercontinental Hotel is a hub of action at Davos, and that same eveni according to [photos posted online](#), WEF founder Klaus Schwab attended “[Mongolia Night](#)” with the nation’s president.

According to draft minutes from the meeting attached in an email to Barak from the IPI, Summers proposed that Mongolia create a sovereign wealth fund to invest “aggressively” in equities using proceeds from commodity exports. He also advised improving relations with the multinational mining company, Rio Tinto. Epstein recommended an evaluation of “all of the country’s financial structures and institutions,” in addition to the sovereign wealth fund. Barak advised that Mongolia’s armed forces should focus on “internal security issues,” especially “the need for go intelligence.” Bondevik described the importance of civil society programs and the “Scandinavian welfare model” as a method of promoting good governance.”



Notes From Mongolia Presidential Advisory Board Meeting
64.9KB · PDF file

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Bondevik would later deny that Epstein was present at the meeting, telling DN that,

Bondevik as its founder and executive chair, went unanswered. Epstein and Barak continued to correspond regularly, with Epstein counseling the former Israeli politician on how to leverage his contacts to make money. On February 21, Epstein wrote to Barak, “with civil unrest exploding in ukraine syria, somolia [sic], libya, and the desperation of those in power, isn’t this perfect for you.” Barak replied: “You’re right a way. But not simple to transform it into a cash flow. A subject for Saturday.”

Re:
From: ehud barak <ehbarak1@gmail.com>
To: Jeffrey Epstein <jeevacation@gmail.com> 2/22/2014, 2:06:06 AM /Search

You're right I n a way. But not simple to transform it into a cash flow. A subject for Saturday.
Best
EB

Sent from my iPhone

On Feb 21, 2014, at 15:10, Jeffrey Epstein <jeevacation@gmail.com> wrote:

with civil unrest exploding in ukraine syria, somolia, libya, and the desperation of those in power, isn't this perfect for you

--

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Barak and Epstein frequently exchanged messages about political subjects, including this message from February 2014 on finding more clients for Barak.

By February 24, 2014, Barak had not yet been paid for his participation in the Advisory Board, and he sent an email to Epstein: “Thx for the time and energy you invest in supporting my efforts to bring home more bread...should I send Terja [sic] my Trans info? Or wait for him to approach me?”

Epstein replied: “yes to terje, im always there for you.”

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“We Should Send it to Jeff”

Epstein’s involvement with the Advisory Board deepened further in the following months. On April 28, 2014, he emailed Barak to set up a phone call to discuss Mongolia. Barak, though a year out of government, was still heavily involved in unofficial national security engagements— high-level state visits as a private citizen consultation on security issues—sometimes followed by an official agreement with Israeli government.

On May 2, 2014, Epstein pinged Barak to remind him to deliver a Mongolia proposal Rød-Larsen. The following day, Barak sent Rød-Larsen a detailed policy memo covering military intelligence, emergency services, and a national rapid response force. He offered a plan to “modernize Sigint, Humint and Visint capabilities”—refer to electronic surveillance and the building of spy networks—“including UAV’s and mobile cellular networks monitoring systems.” The memo also recommended procurement of anti-tank missiles, high-precision artillery, and air defense systems. The proposal’s letterhead bears the official Emblem of Israel, which [requires approval](#) from the Israeli Minister of the Interior, over Barak’s name.



Barak Proposal
906KB · PDF file

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Barak likely stood to gain personally from these policy proposals. In the closing paragraph of the memo, Barak offered “to support Mongolia on other issues like modern agriculture, water [management] (including for the mining industry) and modern medical and diagnostic centers - based on Israeli experience in those areas. Barak was concurrently pursuing his own agreements with several Israeli companies in the fields of mining, agri-biotech, and medical equipment, according to his emails.

For the next year, progress stalled: IPI tried unsuccessfully to schedule a one-on-one follow-up meeting between Barak and President Elbegdorj in late 2014. Then, in March 2015, Epstein loaned Barak \$1,000,000 to fund an early-stage Israeli startup called Reporty Homeland Security. The company was co-founded by Pinhas Buchris, a

high-tech intelligence unit. Reporty (now rebranded as “Carbyne”) enables emergency dispatchers and security services to retrieve precise location data and live video/audio feed from phones. The company was being piloted in local municipalities in Israel, and they planned for an international launch in November 2015.

Re: NY this week

From: jeffrey E. <jeevacation@gmail.com> To: ehbarak <ehbarak1@gmail.com>

9/27/2015, 4:37:08 AM /Inbox

Yes

On Saturday, 26 September 2015, ehbarak <ehbarak1@gmail.com> wrote:

Hi Jeff
Ok. Terja Larsen as well?
Best
EB
Sent from my iPhone

On Sep 26, 2015, at 22:39, jeffrey E. <jeevacation@gmail.com> wrote:

any interest in the mongolian president monday night dinner at my house

On Sat, Sep 26, 2015 at 3:29 PM, ehbarak <ehbarak1@gmail.com> wrote:

Hi Jeff
We're back Sunday afternoon. Will be glad to meet. Now in Aspen. Met Larry Summers. Had a dinner with Josh C Ramo, Ito from Media lab. Met many others.
Let's set a time. We leave NY on Thursday.
Best
EB

Sent from my iPhone

On Sep 26, 2015, at 10:20, jeffrey E. <jeevacation@gmail.com> wrote:

im in town all week

Epstein inviting Barak to dinner at his home in September 2015 with Rød-Larsen and Mongolian government officials.

On September 26, 2015, Epstein invited Barak, Rød-Larsen, President Elbegdorj and Foreign Minister Lundeg Purevsuren to his home in New York for dinner. Purevsuren

Israel. Five days after the dinner, on October 1, Rød-Larsen authorized payment of \$100,000 to Epstein from IPI funds earmarked for the Mongolia Advisory Board, according to [the Norwegian newspaper Dagens Næringsliv \(DN\)](#). IPI has denied that Epstein ever received any payment from the Institute and DN found no explicit confirmation Epstein received the funds.



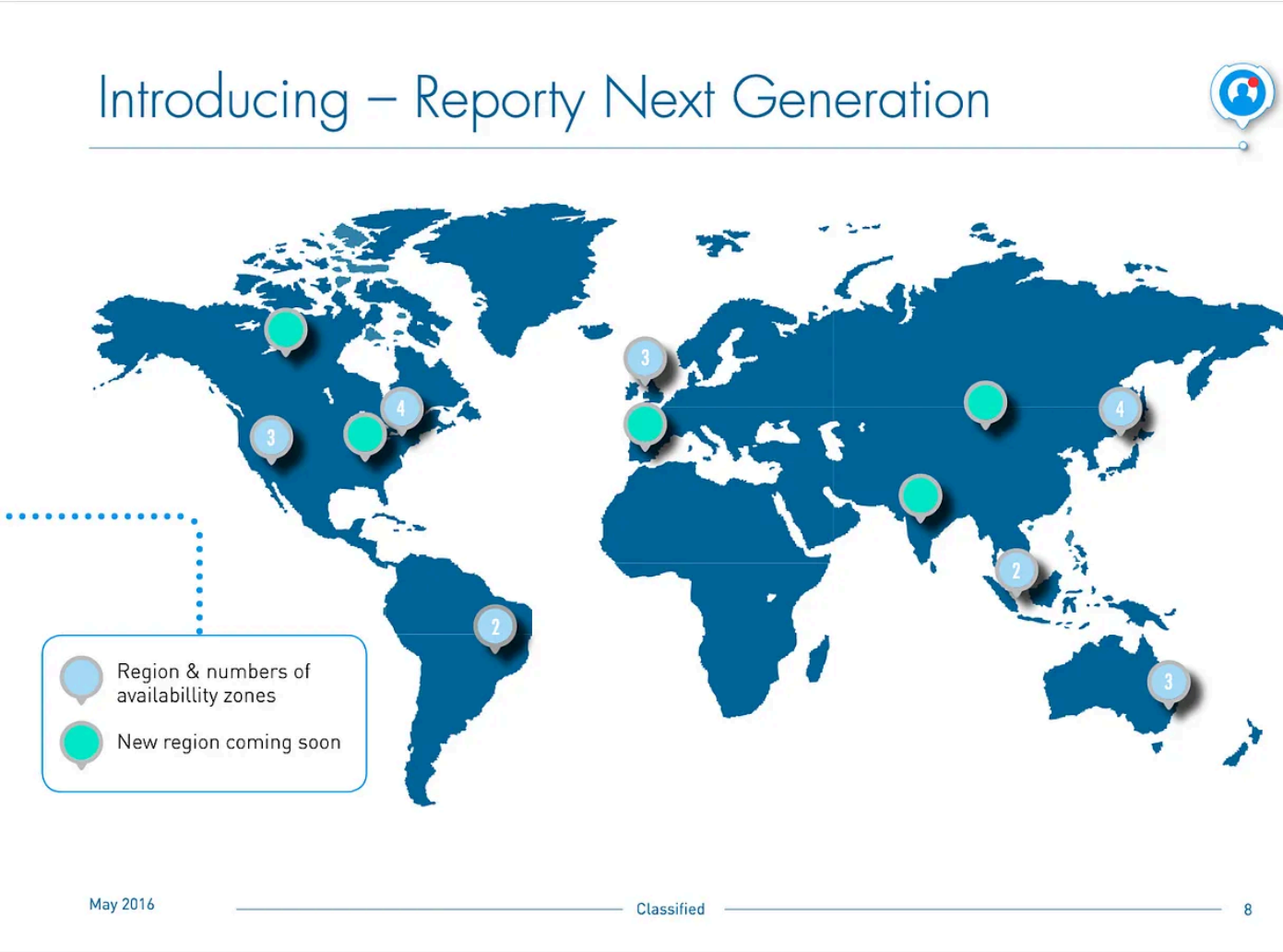
Ehud Barak and wife Nili Priel eat dinner at Epstein's mansion (September 2015)

Internal IPI emails obtained by DN show another effort by Rød-Larsen to compensate Epstein. In January 2016, after Board member Kevin Rudd refused payment for his participation, Rød-Larsen proposed to give Rudd's share to Epstein. He wrote in an email: "For forms sake we should send it to Jeff, however I am sure we will get it back many fold!"

For the next several months, Epstein and Barak pitched Reporty's emergency response platform to potential investors. According to the leaked emails, Epstein arranged for Barak and Reporty co-founder Amir Elichai to meet Peter Thiel's Valar Ventures partners Andrew McCormack and James Fitzgerald in New York in February. After the meeting, McCormack sent a follow-up email politely declining to invest; Valar was not convinced Reporty could "replace" legacy emergency notification systems. Elichai asked McCormack to reconsider: "We are not asking/forcing [governments] to change their current systems...We want to be the 'Man in the middle.'"

The former prime minister used his national security résumé to open more doors: he pitched Reporty to Singapore National Security Minister Teo Chee Hean, and secured a pilot program with the Singaporean government. Barak introduced Elichai to an Israeli investor in Brazil who offered to pitch Reporty to the Rio de Janeiro head of security services.

According to investor materials emailed to Barak, the Reporty team also planned to deploy in Mongolia. A May 2016 investor presentation slide displayed a ‘pin’ on Mongolia with an annotation: “New region coming soon.”



Reporty Homeland Security, May 2016 investor presentation emailed to Barak.

In late 2017, Mongolian and Israeli security officials met in Ulaanbaatar. They [agree](#) to cooperate on emergency services, and discussed “introducing Israeli advanced technology into [the] Mongolian emergency service.” In 2019, medical officers from Israel Defense Forces participated in [joint military exercises](#) with the Mongolian Armed Forces for the first time.

While he played a vital part in helping lay the groundwork for the 2017 agreement between the two countries, based on his private correspondence with Barak it is unclear if Epstein helped execute this final step. Epstein’s emails to Barak’s personal inbox abruptly stopped shortly after April 22, 2016, the week of Ghislaine Maxwell’s

District of New York. Barak's use of his personal email also tapered off around this time.

“Enjoy the Island”

Epstein's alleged ties to foreign governments and intelligence agencies have been a source of speculation for years. But his role in the Mongolia Advisory Board plan and his intimate contacts with Barak, private sector tech firms tied to Israel's security establishment, influential non-governmental organizations, and senior foreign government officials, show for the first time that he engaged in activities that alter the relationship between states—in this case, building formal security ties between the government of Israel and Mongolia.

After Epstein's death in prison, some members of the Mongolia Advisory Board suffered fallout from their connections to him. Rød-Larsen resigned as the president of the IPI in 2020, after revelations that he received a personal loan from Epstein in 2013. The IPI has denied that the loan was connected to Institute activities or finances.

When the scandal of Rød-Larsen's ties with Epstein became public, IPI issued a [statement](#) condemning Epstein, and hired “Big Four” accounting firm KPMG to conduct a [forensic audit](#). The auditors found five donations to IPI from Epstein-affiliated corporate entities between 2010 and 2019, totaling \$650,000. IPI tax filing showed three contributions from Epstein in 2017 alone, amounting to \$375,000. The organization announced that it would donate the equivalent sums to support victims of human trafficking and sexual assault.

IPI declined to comment on issues related to the prior leadership of the organization. Messages sent to an address associated with Larsen did not receive reply. Barak did not respond to a request for comment. Barak has previously denied his continued role in Israeli agreements after leaving office.

In the years since Barak's ties to Epstein became publicly known, the former Israeli prime minister has attempted to downplay their connection. Barak admitted to visiting Epstein at his Manhattan residences and private Caribbean island, and he acknowledged working with Epstein to find business opportunities after leaving public office in Israel. But he said he only saw Epstein “on occasion,” and had no knowledge of his involvement in sex trafficking or abuse of young girls. Describing the disgraced financier as an enigma whose illegal private activities were kept secret, Barak called Epstein “a terrible version of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde.”

The emails reveal a close friendship between the two men. They bonded over music and mathematics, and Epstein at one point wrote Barak: “there are very few people that I enjoy spending time with, you are unique.” Barak often leaned on Epstein for guidance, and in his February 24, 2014 email about payment for the Mongolia Advisory Board, Barak signed off by sending a Skype contact to Epstein and asking him to provide a direct personal evaluation.

“Let me know once you’ve talked to him. And your impression,” Barak wrote. “In the meantime enjoy the Island.”

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The Leaked Ehud Barak Emails

The two email accounts belonging to former Israeli Prime Minister Ehud Barak and leaked by the “Handala Hack Team” in October 2024 contain numerous corroborate details and contact information from Barak and his family and friends, as well as dozens of previously unpublished images and scanned documents from his personal and professional life. These materials reveal information that was not publicly available at the time the email leaks occurred, including a mention of Epstein’s “birthday book,” as well as private photographs, contracts, and memos from Barak’s work with the Mongolia Advisory Board and other consulting roles.

Handala announced the leaked “Israel Prime Minister Emails” on October 2, 2024. The release was accompanied by several of Barak’s private photos, including a “mirror selfie,” a Crusader-inspired knight costume, and the former prime minister’s Israeli passport. Other emails from the leak were [previously](#) reported by Reason Magazine in a story about Epstein’s connections to Barak and individuals in the global tech sector.

Handala is a pro-Palestinian hacking group that first appeared in December 2023, targeting mostly Israeli institutions and political figures for data theft and public leaks.

Researchers have [speculated](#) that Handala is affiliated with Iran’s Ministry of Intelligence. An analysis of the release by Drop Site News discovered a consistent email exporter timestamp offset corresponding to a local timezone of UTC+04:30 (Asia/Kabul, or Iran Daylight Time). Iran stopped observing Daylight Savings Time on September 22, 2022. The Handala dataset coverage ends in 2018, suggesting the files may have been exfiltrated several years before they were published.

Waqas Ahmed contributed reporting



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Bebe Schroer  Sep 28

An amazing, astounding eye-opening report on sickening, obscene maneuvers by operators skulking about in the shadows. Elected governments are irrelevant. I'm supposed to be terrified of Hamas, Hezbollah, Iran, Putin, Xi and Maduro? I'm scared shitless of Washington and Zionists. Oh yeah, and Lindsay "IS-rul" Graham.

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Annie Johnson  Sep 28

It is exactly what we all know in our guts it is. They were underage because they had to be. It was always an Israeli blackmail op.

 LIKE (42)  REPLY



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